

COHEN COX

Cybersecurity • Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning • Systems Engineering • Entrepreneurship

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

High school junior focused on cybersecurity, artificial intelligence, machine learning, and systems engineering. Hands-on experience gained through cybersecurity clinics, Red/Blue Team exercises, CTF competitions, enterprise identity systems, independent technical projects, and entrepreneurship. Proven ability to build, secure, and optimize complex technical environments and lead operational initiatives.

EDUCATION

Foothill High School — Junior

Expected Graduation: 2028 | Las Vegas, NV

TECHNICAL & PROFESSIONAL SKILLS

Cybersecurity: Red Team / Blue Team Tactics, CTF Competitions, Active Directory, Identity & Access Management (IAM), Incident Response

AI / ML: Neural Network Architecture, Backpropagation, Image Processing, Dimensionality Reduction, Local AI Inference & Integration

Systems & Dev: Python, Systems Administration, Active Directory Lab Environments, Enterprise Directory Management, Networking Fundamentals

Business & Leadership: Entrepreneurship, B2B Client Management, Strategic Planning, Conflict Resolution, Time-Sensitive Decision Making

CYBERSECURITY EXPERIENCE & COMPETITIONS

CyberClinic — Junior Member (JM)

2026 – Present

- Support security assessments and hardening efforts to improve the cybersecurity posture of small businesses.
- Translate theoretical security concepts into practical solutions for real-world organizational and technical challenges.
- Collaborate with cross-functional team members to identify vulnerabilities, mitigate risks, and implement security controls.

Rebel Cyber Clinic — Red vs. Blue Exercises

2026

- Participated in authorized Red vs. Blue team simulations within intentionally vulnerable enterprise-grade networks.
- Executed offensive system exploitation concepts and deployed defensive log analysis, host hardening, and incident response.

Cybersecurity Competitions & Capture the Flag (CTF) **DEF CON QUALIFIER**

2025 – Present

- Compete in championship-level CTFs covering security analysis, cryptography, web application security, reverse engineering, and networking.
- **Key Achievement:** Earned DEF CON conference admission through top-tier performance in a regional cybersecurity championship event.

GenCyber Program — Participant

2025

- Completed intensive training in foundational security concepts, threat modeling, vulnerability assessments, and defensive countermeasures.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

5x5 Grayscale Digit Neural Network — Independent AI/ML Project

- Engineered a custom neural network from scratch processing 5x5 grayscale images as 25 numerical pixel inputs with custom backpropagation training.
- Designed a 25 → 20 → 15 → 10 classification architecture paired with a 10 → 15 → 20 → 25 autoencoder-style reconstruction network.
- Achieved **99.95% digit recognition accuracy** while demonstrating dimensionality reduction, representation learning, and image reconstruction.

Active Directory Enterprise Environment — Independent Systems Project

- Deployed and configured a virtualized Active Directory domain controller to analyze enterprise identity and access management (IAM).
- Structured Organizational Units (OUs), Group Policy Objects (GPOs), RBAC permissions, and centralized authentication mechanisms.

Local AI Systems & Inference Workflows — Independent AI Project

- Architected and deployed local LLMs and vision models utilizing open-source frameworks for private, offline inference operations.

ENTREPRENEURSHIP & LEADERSHIP

Praestans Security Group (PSG) — Founder

2026 – Present

- Authored a ~500-page operational launch blueprint detailing technical architecture, MSSP operations, compliance frameworks, pricing, and AI-assisted SOC automation.

Commercial Car Detailing Business — Owner & Operator

- Managed end-to-end business operations including B2B client acquisition, financial planning, logistics, service delivery, and customer retention.

Recreation Assistant

Facility Operations & Customer Support

- Maintain professional facility operations and public-facing relations.

Ice Hockey Lead Supervisor / Official

Officiating & Game Oversight

- Make high-pressure, time-sensitive decisions and resolve player conflicts.

EXTRACURRICULAR HONORS & ACTIVITIES

Foothill High School Band — Tuba & Bass Trombone

2023 – Present

- **Macy's Thanksgiving Day Parade:** Selected member of the band scheduled to perform at the 2027 parade in NYC.
- **Jazz & Concert:** Performed as Bass Trombonist in Jazz Band (Essentially Ellington at UNLV 2025/2026) and 3rd-year Marching Band member.